

# **Integrated Visual Arts Graduate Program**

## **Handbook**



**A Guide for  
Faculty and Students**

## **Department of Art and Visual Culture**

Compiled and Prepared by

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# 2024 – 2025

## IVA Graduate Program Handbook Contents

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This handbook provides information to faculty and students about graduate education in the Master of Fine Arts program in Integrated Visual Arts at Iowa State University (ISU). It serves as a program-specific supplement to the University's *Graduate College Handbook*, available online, which describes general university graduate policies and procedures. You are advised to study the Graduate College website for the handbook and important policy, resource, and calendar/deadline information on a regular basis.

Graduate College Handbook: <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/>

Events and Deadlines: <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/calendar/>

Chapter 7 of the Graduate College Handbook, in particular, is critical to study during your last year. It includes important deadlines, as well as in-depth explanations of the thesis, the final oral examination, and the graduation application. <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/chapter.php?id=7>

# 1. IVA Degree Program and Requirements

## Curriculum

The Integrated Visual Arts program requires a minimum of 63 credits.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Studio Courses</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>42 credits</b>                            |
| ART studio courses                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 27 credits                                   |
| Studio electives outside of ART                                                                                                                                                                                      | 3 credits                                    |
| ART 5720 Critique and Creative Process                                                                                                                                                                               | 6 credits (taken twice in first 4 semesters) |
| Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 6 credits total, consisting of:              |
| ART 6990A: Research                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3 credits                                    |
| ART 6990B: Exhibition                                                                                                                                                                                                | 3 credits                                    |
| <b>Seminar Courses</b>                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>6 Credits</b>                             |
| ART 5110 Seminar in Teaching (3 credits)                                                                                                                                                                             |                                              |
| <i>* if a student does not wish to have an Instructor-of-Record TA position at any point during their program, ARTIS 5110 may be waived. Student will substitute 3 more credits of studio courses for ARTIS 5110</i> |                                              |
| ART 5710: Seminar in Professional Practice (3 credits)                                                                                                                                                               |                                              |
| <b>Art History/Theory/Criticism</b> (See policies on page 4)                                                                                                                                                         | <b>12 credits</b>                            |
| ARTH 5010 required                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 credits                                    |
| Art/Design History courses                                                                                                                                                                                           | 9 credits                                    |
| <b>Related Courses outside the IVA program</b>                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>3 credits</b>                             |
| <b>TOTAL:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>63 credits</b>                            |

## English-language Requirements

Per Graduate College policy, graduate students whose native language is not English, or who do not have a bachelor or advanced degree from ISU or a U.S. institution, or who do not meet the TOEFL or IELTS exemption score range, must take the English Placement Test (EPT) at the beginning of their first semester of enrollment. Information about the EPT is available here: <https://apling.engl.iastate.edu/english-placement-test/>. The EPT has **two components**: EPT Writing and EPT Oral Communication. A student who does not pass one or both parts of this examination will be assigned to one or more English courses. If English coursework is required, it must be completed as early in the program as possible. See section 4.4.3 of the Graduate Handbook: <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/chapter.php?id=4#4.4>

International students who are not native speakers of English, and who have been appointed to a Teaching Assistantship, will further need to pass the Oral English Certification Test (OECT). The OECT is administered before the beginning of fall and spring semesters for first-time test-takers. Information is available at <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/speaking/oect-for-itas>. A TA who does not pass OECT is required to successfully complete GrSt 5400 English for Teaching Purposes. GrST 5400 is an oral communication course designed to help TAs improve English speaking skills necessary for successful teaching.

## Other Program requirements

- End-of-semester exhibition and faculty critique

- For their first four semesters, IVA students will participate in the end-of-semester exhibition. For this public exhibition of current visual work, each student submits a selection of their strongest and most representative work from the semester, accompanied by an artist statement and wall labels for each piece.
- Students will also participate in the end-of-semester faculty critique of this exhibition.
- Regular attendance at IVA program meetings
  - IVA students will meet regularly as a group with the DoGE to discuss matters related to the graduate program, maintenance of studio facilities, and other relevant matters.
- Thesis proposal
  - By the end of the third semester, each IVA student will draft a Thesis Proposal (700-1000 words) in which they outline a body of work to be completed for the MFA Thesis Exhibition.
    - For this proposal, the student will discuss a work or series of works completed during the first three semesters at Iowa State that has been particularly important to their creative research and development. The student will delineate an anticipated direction(s) they would like to pursue, and a cohesive body of work they envision producing for the thesis exhibition.
    - The proposal will be submitted to the student's committee for primary commentary.
    - Helpful link to theses by former students:  
<https://dr.lib.iastate.edu/browse/author>
- Writing consultation with Graduate College Center for Communication Excellence
  - Each IVA student and their major professor should meet with a Writing Consultant from the GCCCE as they begin the thesis writing process, ideally in the 5th semester and no later than the beginning of their 6th semester, to discuss thesis writing and formatting guidelines and questions. See <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/thesisdissertation-consultations>
  - Other GCCCE writing workshops or programming may be recommended or required for individual students, as appropriate for their individual needs and goals. See <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu/>

## **2. Courses, Credits, and Grading**

### **Graduate Courses**

Iowa State University graduate courses are assigned numbers in the 5000s or 6000s.

### **Undergraduate Courses on Graduate Academic Plan: Graduate College Policy**

- With Committee approval, graduate students will be permitted to use undergraduate classes from both within and outside of their majors on their Academic Plan forms.
- No 1000- or 2000-level classes may be used, but 3000- and 4000-level classes at Iowa State (not undergraduate classes from other institutions) will be eligible.
- Students are limited to 9 undergraduate credits, with no more than 3 cr. from 3000 level.
- If a 3000-level class is used, it must be from outside of the student's major.
- Graduate students who take undergraduate classes are not required to do extra work or to be exposed to material more advanced than what is taught to undergraduates.

- In contrast, dual-listed courses (offered at both the undergraduate and graduate level) are required to expect more of graduate students who enroll at the 5000 level.

### Art History Courses

- All Art/Design History courses are subject to committee approval
- ARTH 5010 is required
- At least one additional 5000-level Art/Design History course is required.
- Students may take no more than two 4000-level Art/Design History courses.
- Students must earn a “B” or above on 4000-level Art/Design History courses for them to be used on the Academic Plan.

### Research Credits

Credits for research for the purpose of completing a thesis or dissertation are assigned under the course number 6990. These credits are not calculated in the student’s grade point average (GPA). Six credits of ART 6990 are required for the written Thesis and the MFA Thesis Exhibition.

### Grades and the Academic Plan

For complete information see [Graduate College Handbook, section 5.2](#)

| Grade/<br>Mark | Points/<br>Credits | Performance Description/Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C              | 2.00               | Minimum grade acceptable for courses on the Academic Plan.                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| C-             | 1.67               | A course taken to satisfy degree requirements in which a student receives a C- is not satisfactorily completed and must be repeated, unless a strong case for not repeating is made in writing by the student’s committee and is approved by the dean of the Graduate College. |
| S              |                    | Satisfactory completion (figured in total hours earned but not in GPA). No more than 20% of total credits, excluding 6990 credits, may be earned on an S/F basis.                                                                                                              |
| P              |                    | Passing grade under the P/NP system (figured in total hours earned but not in GPA). Pass/Not Pass Courses may not be used in a Graduate Academic Plan. (See Graduate Handbook.)                                                                                                |

### Probation and Academic Standing

If a graduate student does not maintain a cumulative 3.00 GPA, the Dean of the Graduate College may place the student on academic probation. Grades earned by graduate students in undergraduate courses are included in the calculation of the GPA. Academic probation judgments are made on the basis of grades in coursework only. Refer to Chapter 5 of the ISU Graduate College Handbook for additional information, <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/chapter.php?id=5>.

New, first-term, degree-seeking graduate students who fall below a 3.00 GPA at the end of their first semester at Iowa State University will be given a one-term grace period to bring their grades back to a 3.00 GPA. These students will receive a warning letter from the Graduate College.

### 3. The Graduate Academic Plan & Committee

The Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) acts as academic adviser for graduate students in the first two to three semesters of the program. The DOGE guides the student in selection of courses and development of an Academic Plan until the major professor and committee are selected.

Early selection of a major professor, appointment of a committee, and development of an Academic Plan are very important. **Students are highly encouraged to choose a major professor by the end of their second semester, and to select other members of the committee by the end of their third semester.** The major professor serves as a significant professional mentor. The committee guides and evaluates the student during the remainder of graduate study. Failure to build the committee in a timely manner may have a serious negative impact on the overall quality of the graduate school experience.

#### A. Graduate Committee and Academic Plan in Workday

Students must discuss and seek approval of their desired Academic Plan with their prospective major professor and committee members prior to entering information online. The Academic Plan is the official record of the student's plan of study for their program.

Students will first submit the membership of their Graduate Committee in Workday, as described here: [https://iastate.service-now.com/esc?id=kb\\_article&sysparm\\_article=KB0022887](https://iastate.service-now.com/esc?id=kb_article&sysparm_article=KB0022887)

After their Graduate Committee has been approved, students can submit their Academic Plan in Workday, as described here: [https://iastate.service-now.com/esc?id=kb\\_article&sysparm\\_article=KB0023078](https://iastate.service-now.com/esc?id=kb_article&sysparm_article=KB0023078)

#### B. Graduate Committee Makeup

##### Major Professor

The major professor must be a member of the graduate faculty in the student's declared major. The major professor serves as Chair of the Graduate Committee.

##### Graduate Committee Makeup

The Graduate Committee consists of at least three members of the graduate faculty. At least two members, including the major professor, must be from the declared major or program. At least one member must be from *outside* the student's declared major or program.

#### C. Developing the Academic Plan

The student and the major professor develop the Academic Plan, in consultation with other members of the committee. Each student's Plan should be designed to correct deficiencies in academic preparation, allow for study of subject matter that most interests the student, and avoid repetition in areas where the student is well prepared.

The committee assures that program requirements are met before submitting the Academic Plan. It is highly recommended that the plan be submitted during the third semester of graduate study. The plan must be approved by the Graduate College **no later than the term before the final oral examination.** In order for the form to be approved in any given term, it must be submitted to the Graduate College by the published deadline for that term.

## **D. Graduate Committee Responsibilities: A Summary**

(Full details are in the [Graduate College Handbook, Chapter 6](#))

### **Major Professor (Chair) Responsibilities**

#### **Procedural matters:**

- Review and sign forms requiring the major professor's approval.
- Preside at meetings of the committee.
- Verify that the Academic Plan meets the major requirements (and minor requirements, when applicable) and recommend approval to the Graduate College.
- Communicate with the Dean of the Graduate College regarding changes to a student's Plan, requests for time extensions or delays, changes in a student's status, corrections of probationary status, or other administrative matters.
- Preside over the Final Oral Exam, report results to the Graduate College in a timely manner, and communicate when conditions or other stipulations are met.
- Write letters of recommendation for students as appropriate.

#### **Research and thesis responsibilities:**

- Guide the graduate student through the research process by conferring regularly to review and evaluate progress.
- Guide and advise the student in development of their creative research and preparation of the MFA exhibition.
- Criticize constructively the written draft(s) of a thesis before it is circulated to other members of the committee.
- Work with the student in editing the written draft(s) of the thesis.

#### **The major professor's relationship with the student:**

- Provide needed guidance without hampering independence or creativity.
- Be accessible within a reasonable schedule for discussions with the student.
- Accept a student only if they have sufficient time to direct the student's program and can reasonably expect to support the student to the completion of the degree.
- Write letters of recommendation for the student and aid with job or position placement as appropriate.
- Inform the student of any special leave that may cause inconvenience or delay in the student's research progress or in the arrangement of the preliminary oral or final oral examinations.

#### **Resolution of major professor-student relationship problems:**

- When irreconcilable problems occur between the major professor and student, it may be advisable to dissolve the relationship. The DOGE is responsible for recommending to the Graduate College that the original graduate committee be dissolved and that a new committee be formed.

### **Graduate Committee Member Responsibilities**

#### **Procedural matters:**

- Review the student's progress periodically.

- Review the Academic Plan to verify that it meets the major requirements (and minor requirements, when applicable).
- Discuss and recommend changes to the student's program.

#### **Committee/Student Relationships:**

- Inform the student of any circumstances that might cause inconvenience in arranging periodic meetings or the preliminary oral or final oral examinations.
- Write letters of recommendations for the student.

#### **Research and thesis responsibilities:**

- Advise the student during development of the thesis, either individually or in conference with other committee members.
- Read the written thesis critically and suggest corrections.
- Participate in the final oral examination and recommend whether the degree should be granted.

### **Student Responsibilities**

#### **Procedural matters:**

- Submit all forms requiring approval in advance of Graduate College deadlines.
- Identify appropriate members to serve on the graduate committee, and communicate with them in a timely manner.
- Submit the names of the Graduate Committee Members in Workday
- After the Graduate Committee has been approved, and after obtaining agreement from the major professor and committee members, complete the Academic Plan form with assistance from the major professor. Submit it through Workday for approval by the major professor, committee members, DOGE and the Graduate College. Remember, Academic Plans must be approved by the Graduate College *the semester before* the semester of graduation.

#### **Relationship with the major professor:**

- Meet with the major professor regularly, as often as possible or necessary, to discuss research progress and/or problems and to review progress on the thesis.
- Develop and, if necessary, regularly revise an agenda with the major professor.
- Submit to the major professor all required forms for signature in a reasonable time frame.
- Inform the major professor of personal leave and sick leave. Personal leave should be planned so it does not interfere with the student's duties.
- Be accessible to the major professor for meetings and check-ins.
- Provide drafts of the thesis to the major professor in time for adequate review before submission deadlines.

#### **Relationship with the Graduate Committee:**

- Schedule all committee meetings for discussion of the written thesis, exhibition, and expectations for the final oral examination.
- Be accessible periodically and within a reasonable schedule for discussion with members of the committee.
- Submit a full draft of the thesis to the committee members at least two weeks before the final oral examination.



## Director of Graduate Education (DOGE)

The DOGE is the graduate program coordinator for the Integrated Visual Arts program. Responsibilities include signing for the major, approval of Graduate Committees and Academic Plans, and general oversight of the graduate major. The DOGE also calls meetings of program faculty and leads discussions of issues important to the major.

## 4. Integrated Visual Arts Thesis

“A master’s thesis is a scholarly composition that demonstrates the ability of the author to do independent and creative work. It explores in some depth a problem or issue related to the major field of study. **Although considerable variations in format and style are acceptable, precise expression, logical construction, and meticulous attention to detail are essential.** A thesis is required in all fields in which a master’s degree is awarded, except where specific provision is made for a nonthesis degree program. A minimum of three research credits is required on every program of study for a thesis master’s degree. Since satisfactory completion of the dissertation or thesis can constitute one of the most gratifying experiences in graduate study, **the document should reflect the highest standards of scholarship, serving as a measure of quality for the student, major professor, the program, and Iowa State University.** Responsibility for writing and editing of the dissertation or thesis rests with the student, under the supervision of the major professor, and not with the Graduate College. The Graduate College does not permit joint authorship of dissertations or theses. It is the responsibility of the major professor to supervise the preparation of preliminary and final drafts of the dissertation or thesis, to assure the highest level of quality when the student presents the dissertation or thesis to the committee for final approval. Please refer to the [Graduate College Dissertation/Thesis website](#) for requirements, fees, and other pertinent information.”

[ISU Graduate Handbook section 7.1](#)

### The Three Integrated Visual Arts Thesis Components

The graduate student will work with their committee to establish the direction and goals for the written and visual thesis. The following considerations provide general guidelines for the MFA thesis in the Integrated Visual Arts program.

#### 1. Exhibition

The exhibition is the most important component of the thesis. The majority of work in the graduate thesis exhibition must be produced specifically for the thesis. Work created before thesis credit may be included in the exhibition, in a supplementary role, if it supports the thesis. The graduate thesis exhibition will consist of work(s) resulting from in-depth development of the student’s chosen visual, technical, and conceptual concerns. The committee must approve the venue for the thesis exhibition. Each student should work closely with their major professor and request critiques from their committee members as they develop their thesis work.

#### 2. Written Component

Generally, the written thesis for a visual artist is focused on the visual, technical, and conceptual foundation of their work with an analysis of its relationship to the larger art community. The student should be able to relate their work to other artists’ works, both contemporary and

historical. Other influences beyond art, such as cultural, scientific, psychological, etc., may also be addressed. The structure of the written thesis varies depending on each individual's focus. Visual examples of work as well as a bibliography must be included. For more detailed information and directions regarding required formatting, please refer to the Graduate College guidelines at <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/thesis/>

Copies of all theses written since 2010 are available in Parks Library's University Digital Repository, <https://dr.lib.iastate.edu/home>. The format and length of the written component has varied for IVA students from about 25 pages to nearly 200; but most theses are in the 40- to 50-page range.

### 3. Final Oral Examination

The final oral examination by the Graduate Committee must occur once the exhibition has been installed but **before the opening**. The oral examination focuses upon the work(s), the overall exhibition, and the written thesis. The written thesis must be fully drafted prior to the oral examination, and must be sent to the committee *at least two weeks* prior to the oral examination.

#### Academic Writing Support for Graduate Students

The Center for Communication Excellence at the Graduate College <https://cce.grad-college.iastate.edu> offers many opportunities for graduate students to master written and oral communication skills. Services offered by the CCE include:

- Graduate Peer Review Groups: Join a small group of peers in the same or similar discipline to give and receive feedback on your research writing and to make revisions in real time.
- Research Writing Seminar Series
- Individual feedback and guidance: Schedule appointments with the writing consultants.
  - English Writing: If you are an international student and need help with organization, structure, vocabulary, grammar, and fluency to ensure that your ideas are effectively communicated in English, work one-on-one with the English Writing Consultant.
  - Research writing: If you want to improve your abstract, introduction, methods, results, discussion, or conclusion sections/chapters, get feedback from the [Disciplinary Writing Consultants](#). Communication Consultants welcome graduate students from all disciplines. Bring any type of document, including portfolios, teaching philosophies, cover letters, research presentations, etc. Graduate consultation sessions can be walk-in or by appointment. Limited satellite hours are also available.

### 5. Graduate Studios

The Integrated Visual Arts Graduate Studios are located in the College of Design, room 316. (Studios in other locations may be offered if space becomes unavailable in the main location). We hope that you will establish a strong relationship to this facility. All IVA students have access to the facility. It is critical that all students show consideration to each other and respect the College of Design property that you will occupy. You will be issued a door pass code and have 24/7 access to the studio. You must follow all policies and procedures given in the Integrated Visual Arts Studio Contract (see Appendix). You must remove all of your belongings and restore the space to the condition you found it within 7 days following graduation from the IVA program, or after 3 years (6 semesters) of use, whichever comes first. Students will continue to have access to studio space over the summers, provided they are registered for continued full-time study in the coming Fall. All IVA students must sign the IVA Studio Contract each semester.

## 6. Graduate Assistantship Policy for 2024-25

Graduate students who are awarded a teaching, research, or administrative assistantship receive both a stipend and a tuition scholarship. Per ISU policy, students pursuing an MFA, the discipline's accepted terminal degree, who are awarded a quarter-time assistantship receive in-state resident tuition rates, a tuition scholarship equal to one-half resident graduate tuition, a monthly stipend, free health insurance, and a reduction in some student fees. Details on this policy can be found at <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/finance/assistantships/>

There are a limited number of assistantships available each semester. For an IVA student to be considered for an assistantship within the department, the student must meet the following requirements:

- Have a minimum 3.00 GPA.
- Enroll full-time (at least 9 credits) each semester they are on assistantship.
- Meet all departmental deadlines toward matriculation as defined in the *MFA Procedures* section of this handbook.
- Be enrolled in the first six semesters of their program (IVA assistantships are awarded for no more than six semesters).
- Receive positive performance evaluations (see below and Appendix)
- Adhere to program requirements, including participation in end-of-semester exhibitions and attendance at required meetings

### Graduate Assistant Evaluation Policy

Each Graduate Assistant must be assessed toward the end of each semester of employment. Faculty supervisors are expected to discuss their evaluations with the GA assigned to them. Students have the opportunity to respond to their evaluations. At least one classroom observation for Instructor-of-Record TAs during the first semester of teaching is required. The faculty member will submit copies of the evaluation to the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) and to the Graduate Assistant. (See Appendix for evaluation forms.)

## 7. Timeline for the MFA in Integrated Visual Arts

| Year One (First 21 Credits)        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advising</b>                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Department DOGE serves as your adviser.</li> <li>• By the end of the second semester you should have identified a Major Professor and begun working with them to identify other possible committee members.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Courses</b>                     | <p>One semester should include 9 credits and the other 12.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Four ART studio courses.</li> <li>• One ARTH course.</li> <li>• Art 5720: Seminar in Critique and Creative Practice (offered Spring)</li> <li>• One section of Art 5710: Seminar in Professional Practice; or Art 5110: Seminar in Teaching.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Research</b>                    | <p>Your focus for the first two semesters is exploration in both studio and research.</p> <p><b>First-Semester Research Requirements:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• You are expected to arrange meetings to discuss your work with a minimum of 3 faculty with whom you are not currently taking classes, with the goal of identifying faculty from both within and outside of the department who might be able to serve on your graduate committee.</li> <li>• You will participate in the End-of-Semester Review Exhibition, a public exhibition of current visual work. You will submit a grouping of your strongest and most representative work from the semester. Please include an Artist Statement, as well as wall labels for each piece</li> <li>• You will participate in the end-of-semester critique of this exhibition</li> </ul> <p><b>Second-Semester Research Requirements:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• By the end of the second semester, you are expected to identify a major professor and begin working with them to identify other possible committee members.</li> <li>• You will participate in the End-of-Semester Review Exhibition. Please include an Artist Statement, as well as wall labels for each piece</li> <li>• You will participate in the end-of-semester critique of this exhibition</li> </ul> |
| <b>Professional Activities</b>     | <p>Begin or continue to develop professional engagement, including exhibitions, lectures, gallery work, website, etc. Seek out professional development organizations within your field of research.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Graduate College Procedures</b> | <p>Non-native English speakers meet the <a href="#">Graduate English requirements</a>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

| Year Two (24 Credits; total 45 Credits overall by end of 4th semester) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advising</b>                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Department DoGE serves as adviser, in cooperation with the Major professor.</li> <li>• By the end of the third semester, identify all graduate committee members and submit the committee membership in Workday.</li> <li>• Work with committee to design your Academic Plan.</li> <li>• Complete the Academic Plan in Workday by the end of the fourth semester.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Courses</b>                                                         | <p>Each semester will include 12 credits.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Three ART studio courses.</li> <li>• Two ARTH courses.</li> <li>• Art 5720: Seminar in Critique and Creative Practice (offered Spring)</li> <li>• One section of ART 5710: Seminar in Professional Practice or ART 5110: Seminar in Teaching</li> <li>• One studio or related course outside the department</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Research</b>                                                        | <p><b>Third-Semester Research Requirements:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Announce your graduate committee by the middle of your third semester.</li> <li>• By the end of the third semester, draft a Thesis Proposal (700-1000 words) in which you outline a body of work that you will complete for your MFA Thesis Exhibition. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Discuss a work or series of works you completed during your first three semesters that has advanced your creative research and development.</li> <li>○ Then describe an anticipated direction(s) you would like to pursue, and a cohesive body of work you envision producing for your thesis exhibition.</li> <li>○ Use high-quality images to illustrate your proposal, as appropriate. Include captions giving title, date, size, and medium.</li> <li>○ Submit proposal to DoGE and graduate committee for comment.</li> <li>○ Look at theses by former students (see list below)</li> </ul> </li> <li>• You will participate in the End-of-Semester Review Exhibition. Please include an Artist Statement and wall labels for each piece.</li> <li>• You will participate in the end-of-semester critique of this exhibition</li> </ul> <p><b>Fourth Semester Research Requirements:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• You will participate in the End-of-Semester Review Exhibition. Please include an Artist Statement and wall labels for each piece.</li> <li>• You will participate in the end-of-semester critique of this exhibition</li> <li>• Meet with each member of your graduate committee during the semester.</li> <li>• <b>Reserve a gallery space for your thesis exhibition</b> (see Final Oral Examination, Final Semester notes below). Notify your committee and the DoGE of this information.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Professional Activities</b>                                         | <p>Develop professional engagement, including exhibitions, lectures, gallery work, website, lectures, etc. Get involved with professional organizations in your field of research. Work on your artist's statement, resume, cover letters, etc., and research employment opportunities. Document your visual work with high-quality images.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

| Year Three – Fifth Semester (9 to 12 Credits; total 54 to 57 credits by end of semester) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Advising</b>                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Major professor serves as your academic adviser, with input and support from the DoGE. Meet with the major professor regularly throughout the semester.</li> <li>● Schedule at least one committee meeting per semester to gauge progress.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Courses</b>                                                                           | <p>This semester includes 9 to 12 credits.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Two credits ART 6990A: Research: Thesis (written).</li> <li>● One credit ART 6990B: Research: Thesis Exhibition (visual).</li> <li>● One ART studio course.</li> <li>● One section of ART 5710: Seminar in Professional Practice or ART 5110: Seminar in Teaching (if not already completed).</li> <li>● One studio or related course outside the department.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Thesis</b>                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● If you haven't, <b>reserve a gallery space</b> for your thesis exhibition.</li> <li>● With the guidance of your major professor, committee members, and Graduate College resources, initiate a draft of the thesis including: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Artist's statement.</li> <li>○ Historical, artistic, and conceptual context.</li> <li>○ Discussion of your earlier work.</li> <li>○ Discussion of your visual thesis work and exhibit.</li> </ul> </li> <li>● With your major professor, schedule a meeting with a Writing Consultant at the Graduate College Center for Communication Excellence, to discuss thesis formatting requirements.</li> <li>● For thesis tips and resources refer to: <a href="https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/thesis/">https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/thesis/</a></li> <li>● Schedule at least one meeting of your full graduate committee <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Show work completed during the current semester.</li> <li>○ Discuss plans for thesis exhibition, and share work completed for exhibition and written thesis.</li> <li>○ Notify DOGE when the review is complete.</li> <li>○ Failure to meet with the committee each of these two semesters indicates you are not meeting departmental deadlines toward matriculation. Benefits such as assistantships may be withdrawn.</li> </ul> </li> <li>● Attend the end-of-semester review. You have the option to display your work in that exhibit, but you must make a request with the DoGE in advance. The DoGE will grant approval based on space availability.</li> <li>● If displaying work in the end-of-semester review, include wall labels and artist statement.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Professional Activities</b>                                                           | <p>Refine artist's statement, resume, cover letters, etc.</p> <p>Document your visual work with professional-quality images.</p> <p>Continue to research employment opportunities and apply for positions.</p> <p>Continue involvement in professional activities.</p> <p>Attend meetings and conferences of professional organizations within your area of research.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

| Year Three – Final Semester (9 Credits; total 63 credits by end of semester) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Adviser</b>                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Major professor serves as your academic adviser, with input and support from the DoGE. Meet with the major professor regularly throughout the semester.</li> <li>Schedule at least one committee meeting <i>prior to</i> the oral exam.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Courses</b>                                                               | <p>This semester includes 9 credits.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>One credit ART 6990A: Research: Thesis (written).</li> <li>Two credits ART 6990B: Research: Thesis Exhibition (visual).</li> <li>One ART studio course.</li> <li>One ARTH course.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Thesis</b>                                                                | <p>With the guidance of your major professor, committee members, and Graduate College resources, complete the written thesis including:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Artist's statement.</li> <li>Historical, artistic, and conceptual context.</li> <li>Discussion of your earlier work.</li> <li>Discussion of your visual thesis work and exhibit.</li> </ul> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>If you haven't already, with your major professor, schedule a meeting with a Writing Consultant at the Graduate College Center for Communication Excellence, to discuss thesis formatting requirements.</li> </ul> <p>Complete the visual thesis work; plan and install the exhibition.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Professional Activities</b>                                               | Complete documentation of your visual work and related professional engagement.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Grad College Procedures</b>                                               | <p>Apply for Graduation (Check <a href="#">deadline</a>: early in semester).<br/> The requirements related to graduation can be found <a href="#">here</a>.<br/> Submit <b>Request for Final Oral Examination</b> through the Graduate College <u>at least 3 weeks before the examination date</u>.<br/> The Oral Examination:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Must occur while your exhibition is up.</li> <li>Must be scheduled when all committee members can be present.</li> <li>Must be scheduled before the last approved date for oral exams.</li> </ul> <p>In addition:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>You must provide your <b>completed</b> written thesis to committee members <b>at least 2 weeks</b> before final examination.</li> <li>You must successfully pass the Final Oral Examination and your major professor must immediately submit the report form to Graduate College.</li> <li>Once you pass your Final Oral Examination and make any requested changes to your thesis, the major professor(s) and DOGE will sign your Graduate Student Approval Slip for Graduation. All incompletes and Non-Report grades from previous terms must be resolved, and any conditions placed on the final oral examination must be removed. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The signed Graduate Student Approval Form must be submitted to the Graduate College by the deadline of the appropriate term.</li> <li>Complete the Thesis Checklist</li> <li><a href="#">Upload your thesis to ProQuest</a>. Note deadlines for uploading.</li> <li>Upon email acceptance by the Graduate College, you will be able to graduate.</li> </ul> </li> </ul> |

**University Non-discrimination Statement**

Iowa State University does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, age, ethnicity, religion, national origin, pregnancy, sexual orientation, gender identity, genetic information, sex, marital status, disability, or status as a U.S. Veteran. Inquiries regarding non-discrimination policies may be directed to Office of Equal Opportunity, 3410 Beardshear Hall, 515 Morrill Road, Ames, Iowa 50011, Tel. 515-294-7612, Hotline 515-294-1222, email [eooffice@iastate.edu](mailto:eooffice@iastate.edu).



## 8. LIST OF IVA ALUMNI & THEIR THESIS TITLES

| Name                     | Date    | Thesis Title                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Leising, Rachel          | Fall 04 | <i>Self-Representations: Exposure/Disguise</i>                                                                                                         |
| Atwell, Robert           | Fall 02 | <i>Dot on a Walk</i>                                                                                                                                   |
| Faber, Carol             | Spr 04  | <i>Fragments of Nature/Laid to Rest</i>                                                                                                                |
| Holtze, Mary             | Spr 06  | <i>Amalgamations</i>                                                                                                                                   |
| Grover, Trent            | Fall 08 | <i>Dream of the Techno-Shaman</i>                                                                                                                      |
| Vredenburg, David (Zane) | Fall 07 | <i>Food Fight</i>                                                                                                                                      |
| Thompson, Nancy          | Spr 08  | <i>Ode to the White Rock Conservancy</i>                                                                                                               |
| Robinson, Eric           | Spr 09  | <i>Perception, Understanding &amp; Belief Through Wood Cut &amp; Monotype Prints of the Parable of the Sower &amp; the Crucifixion of Jesus Christ</i> |
| Kamrath, Jon             | Spr 08  | <i>Family Tools</i>                                                                                                                                    |
| Stanley, Michael         | Spr 08  | <i>Katrina's Crescendo</i>                                                                                                                             |
| Okumura, Hiromi          | Fall 09 | <i>State of Being-Perpetual Motion: Beauty Spreading Like Water</i>                                                                                    |
| Hong, Sunki              | Spr 10  | <i>Nature, Culture, &amp; Emotion: Objects of Wood, Metal &amp; Stone</i>                                                                              |
| Hood, Amanda             | Spr 10  | <i>Nearly Gone</i>                                                                                                                                     |
| Seidle, Larrison         | Fall 11 | <i>An Uncertain Stability</i>                                                                                                                          |
| Kral, Anastasia          | Spr 11  | <i>Memory: Beauty, Fragmentation &amp; Image</i>                                                                                                       |
| Streeter, Paula          | Fall 11 | <i>Turned Pates/The Artist Book in the Age of Technology</i>                                                                                           |
| Corones, Matthew         | Spr 12  | <i>Analytic Hyperrealism in Photography Remodeling the Study of Light Through Computational Modes of Exploring Image Making</i>                        |
| Friend, Naomi            | Spr 13  | <i>Arable Visions</i>                                                                                                                                  |
| Weyand, Kara             | Spr 13  | <i>Into the Hinterland</i>                                                                                                                             |
| Hall, Amanda Hall        | Sum 13  | <i>Playing House: Exploring Domesticity Gone Awry</i>                                                                                                  |
| Nagel, Molly             | Sum 13  | <i>Beasts of Earth &amp; Spirit</i>                                                                                                                    |
| Stamy, Celinda           | Spr 14  | <i>Tunnel Vision</i>                                                                                                                                   |
| Lynch, Wyeth             | Sum 14  | <i>Constructing Realities</i>                                                                                                                          |
| Dao, Stephanie           | Spr 15  | <i>Collective World: Interdisciplinary Collaboration &amp; Communication in the Visual Arts</i>                                                        |
| Jomepour, Rahele         | Spr 15  | <i>Women in Iran: Ancient History to Modern Times, &amp; Back</i>                                                                                      |
| Lee, Sodam               | Spr 15  | <i>Changing Perceptions &amp; the Impact of Culture</i>                                                                                                |
| Nissen, Lindsay          | Spr 15  | <i>Metaregionalism</i>                                                                                                                                 |
| Pan, Hua                 | Spr 15  | <i>Women in a Box</i>                                                                                                                                  |
| Rock, Earle              | Spr 15  | <i>The Lens of Empathy</i>                                                                                                                             |
| Whittlesey, Heather      | Spr 15  | <i>Tensegrity</i>                                                                                                                                      |
| Friess, Nick             | Spr 15  | <i>art I facs</i>                                                                                                                                      |
| Kummitha, Rohini         | Sum 15  | <i>Magic Masala</i>                                                                                                                                    |
| Sloan, Devin Vaughn      | Fall 15 | <i>Curious cut-aways</i>                                                                                                                               |
| Ishikawa, Josianne Marie | Spr 16  | <i>Transitory Nature</i>                                                                                                                               |
| Dwyer, Alexis            | Spr 16  | <i>Casey Land Rambles</i>                                                                                                                              |
| Xue, Fei                 | Sum 16  | <i>An Examination of Chinese Philosophical Concepts and Audience Through Animation</i>                                                                 |
| Liu, Xin                 | Sum 16  | <i>Mr. Acephalous: The procedure of the individual stop-motion animation</i>                                                                           |
| Chen, Xiaohan            | Spr 17  | <i>World in a Flower</i>                                                                                                                               |

|                        |         |                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alsbury, Bridgette     | Spr 17  | <i>Food Pirates: An Exploration of Food, Technology, and the Future Through Sequential Art</i>         |
| Greiner, Mathew B.     | Spr 17  | <i>Inconsequential Plan for Reorganizing the Value of Art in the Public Sphere</i>                     |
| Obbink, Matthew Brian  | Fall 17 | <i>Building Eugene</i>                                                                                 |
| Chen, Xin              | Fall 17 | <i>Culture and My Art</i>                                                                              |
| Rice, Kristina         | Spr 18  | <a href="#"><u>Left/Over Objects</u></a>                                                               |
| Carlson, Taylor M.     | Spr 18  | <a href="#"><u>The power of belief: Implementing self-efficacy in the studio and the classroom</u></a> |
| Jenkins, Robert David  | Spr 18  | <a href="#"><u>Resurrection</u></a>                                                                    |
| Deutmeyer, Rachel      | Spr 18  | <a href="#"><u>Traces: A Farm in Eastern Iowa</u></a>                                                  |
| Zandt, Andrew          | Spr 19  | <a href="#"><u>Time, Action, Wear, Memory</u></a>                                                      |
| Segner, Anna Noel      | Spr 19  | <a href="#"><u>Toy (with) Animals</u></a>                                                              |
| Long, Judy Jane        | Spr 19  | <a href="#"><u>The Veil</u></a>                                                                        |
| Johnson, Dan           | Fall 19 | <a href="#"><u>Transmogrify</u></a>                                                                    |
| Godfrey, Sarah         | Spr 20  | <a href="#"><u>Shards and Scraps</u></a>                                                               |
| Gray, Cameron          | Spr 20  | <a href="#"><u>The Coronation</u></a>                                                                  |
| Nutt, Daniel           | Spr 20  | <a href="#"><u>Sediments of Identity</u></a>                                                           |
| Beul, Jasmine          | Fall 20 | <a href="#"><u>The Alien Landscape</u></a>                                                             |
| Holzbauer, Paige       | Spr 21  | <a href="#"><u>Restoration</u></a>                                                                     |
| Liu, Nan-Teng          | Spr 21  | <a href="#"><u>Unforgotten: The essentials of clear storytelling in comics</u></a>                     |
| Yanulis, Christopher   | Fall 21 | <a href="#"><u>Thinking Out Loud</u></a>                                                               |
| Chiavetta, Christopher | Spr 22  | <a href="#"><u>Becoming Ecological</u></a>                                                             |
| Lee, Youeun            | Sum 22  | <a href="#"><u>Cultural Storytelling: Korea</u></a>                                                    |
| Zhang, Li              | Fall 22 | <a href="#"><u>Exploration and Integration: Toward a Future</u></a>                                    |
| Reeves, Elizabeth      | Spr 23  | <a href="#"><u>WTLI: Where the Light Is</u></a>                                                        |
| DuVal Mihelich, Katie  | Fall 23 | <a href="#"><u>The Intersection of Grief and Gratitude</u></a>                                         |
| Killin, Alyssa         | Fall 23 | <a href="#"><u>Ecowomanist aesthetics: Art, ecology, and activism</u></a>                              |
| Tate, Amenda           | Fall 23 | <a href="#"><u>Situational identities: This &amp; something else</u></a>                               |

# Appendix 1:

## Professional Goals for Graduate Art Students

Compiled by Professor April Katz, DOGE 2014-2017 (Revised from Prof. Beauvais Lyons, U. Tennessee-Knoxville)

The Master of Fine Arts (MFA) is not the same as an undergraduate degree. It does not simply consist of completing a list of courses. Aim to develop a set of skills that will enable you to continue to work professionally as an artist.

The following list of professional goals is intended to help you assess your strengths and weaknesses in preparation for your terminal degree. The list is based on professional experience, knowledge of job candidate pools as a search committee chairperson, and job descriptions from recent listings. Even if you don't intend to teach, this list can serve as a benchmark for preparation in related art fields.

### I. Technical Skills

1. Knowledge and demonstrated ability in a variety of skills related to your studio practice.
2. Knowledge and demonstrated ability in two or more of the following:
  - a) drawing
  - b) design and/or foundations
  - c) photography and photo-print methods
  - d) digital practice
  - d) three-dimensional forms
  - e) time-based studio practice

### II. Theoretical Aptitude

1. Ability to articulate comprehension of the history, contemporary practice, and aesthetics of art with an emphasis on your particular areas of focus.

### III. Professional Skills

1. Strong verbal skills (public speaking, critiquing, etc.).
2. Strong written expression (artist's statements, grant applications, reviews).
3. Organizational skills (project planning and implementation, budgeting, delegation of responsibilities).
4. Proven teaching experience.

### IV. Professional Goals before Graduation

1. Develop a strong, ambitious body of work.
2. Inclusion in five or more national juried competitions.
3. One or more published articles or reviews (*art papers, media-specific newsletter, online journal*).
4. Present two or more lectures or public presentations.
5. Organize and curate an exhibition with a catalog.
6. Obtain gallery representation.
7. Develop a personal website.
8. Organize a regional symposium of graduate students.

### V. Professional Development Plan

1. Service experience.
2. Communication experience.
3. Professional engagement: professional associations.

## Appendix 2: Forms



### IVA Graduate Studios: Design room 316

#### Integrated Visual Arts Studio Contract 2023-24

IVA students have 24/7 access to the studio. This is your space to explore, experiment, create and dialogue with each other. We hope that you will establish meaningful relationships to this facility and to the other students using the space.

#### Studio Rules & Considerations:

You access the studio through the keypad code. Don't share the code with anyone.

You can prop the door open to move objects in and out of the studio, but when you are done **lock the door**. Do not leave the studio open for any length of time.

No firearms or weapons are allowed in the studio.

No animals are allowed on the premises.

No alcohol or drugs are to be stored or consumed on the premises.

You may not use the studio or any part of the facility to lodge or sleep in overnight.

You may have a small number of guests for short periods of time. They must not disturb other IVA graduate students or enter other students' studio spaces during their visit.

If you wish to bring more than four visitors at a time into the studio, please get approval from the DoGE and other users of the space.

Visitors are permitted, but if you believe a visitor is uninvited and has no business in the facility, please report this immediately to the ISU Department of Public Safety, 515-294-4428. In the event of an emergency situation, call **911**.

Only IVA students may use the IVA designated studio to create art/design.

Space in the studio is limited. If studio space reaches capacity, priority will be given to full-time students, and/or to students who are farther advanced in their studies. Students taking extra time to finish their degrees may not be granted a studio space past their sixth semester of enrollment.

Music should be played only on personal devices, with headphones or earbuds. Keep volume low enough that others cannot hear your music. Please remain aware of your surroundings, and use caution with noise-canceling devices.

Make every attempt to keep your creative activity within your designated space. If your projects demand more space, make arrangements with the DOGE. Do not encroach on the designated space of others.

Keep your area and the common areas tidy after each use. Do not leave food lying around; it attracts vermin.

When you move out of a space or graduate, you are responsible for clearing out your belongings, cleaning your space, spackling and painting your walls/partitions if applicable.

Problems with the facility such as burned-out lightbulbs, non-functioning outlets, etc. should be reported to the Building Supervisor, Jeremy Thurlby, at 515-294-9799 or [jthurlby@iastate.edu](mailto:jthurlby@iastate.edu).

Risk Management requests that all incidents resulting in bodily injury or property damage be reported to it. Information can be found on its website: <https://www.riskmanagement.iastate.edu/Report>. If an incident occurs, also notify the DOGE by email.

**I agree to these terms and conditions for the use of the Room 316 Studios.**

Sign\_\_\_\_\_Date\_\_\_\_\_

Print your name\_\_\_\_\_

There may be additional rules/regulations added to this list as new necessities are identified.

## Graduate Assistant Evaluation

Please provide an accurate and candid assessment of your Graduate Assistant's work toward the end of each semester of employment. Faculty supervisors are expected to discuss their evaluations with the GA assigned to them. Students also have the opportunity to respond to their evaluations. At the time of the discussion between the GA and the faculty supervisor, both parties should complete both sides of this form and sign it. The faculty member will submit the evaluation to the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) and to the Graduate Assistant.

Semester \_\_\_\_\_ Year \_\_\_\_\_ Class/Research Title \_\_\_\_\_  
 GA Name \_\_\_\_\_ Faculty Name \_\_\_\_\_

| Supervisor Ranking of GA Only as Applicable                    | Meets Expectations | Below Expectations | N/A | Comments (Required if Unsatisfactory) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|-----|---------------------------------------|
| Dependability: Sense of responsibility, punctuality, etc.      |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Consistent communication with supervising faculty.             |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Ability to work in a disciplined fashion.                      |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Initiative: Works independently, solves problems.              |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Professionalism: Attitude, maturity, collegiality.             |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Grading: Knowledge of material, fairness, timeliness.          |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Preparation for each week's work.                              |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Knowledge/skills/conceptual understanding.                     |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Research: Technique, diligence, accuracy.                      |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Teaching: Lectures, discussions, demonstrations, availability. |                    |                    |     |                                       |
| Studio/facility/technological maintenance.                     |                    |                    |     |                                       |

At least one classroom observation for **teacher-of-record TAs** during the first semester of teaching is required.

(If first observation is okay, additional observations are not needed but may be requested by the GA or faculty in the future.)

| Observation Attached | Yes | No | Not Applicable | Date of Observation |
|----------------------|-----|----|----------------|---------------------|
|----------------------|-----|----|----------------|---------------------|

Did the GA report for work during the first contract week?

Did the GA maintain contact with supervisor?

**Overall Ranking:**

**Meets Expectations**

**Below Expectations**

**Additional Comments?**

**(GAs have the right after discussing and signing the evaluation with the faculty supervisor to submit their own self-evaluation and comments to the DoGE)**

\_\_\_\_\_  
FACULTY SIGNATURE

\_\_\_\_\_  
DATE

\_\_\_\_\_  
STUDENT SIGNATURE

\_\_\_\_\_  
DATE

## Graduate Assistant Teaching Observation Form

Please provide an accurate and candid assessment of your Graduate Assistant's teaching. Teaching assistants are expected to provide and discuss their course syllabus with their supervisor prior to the scheduled observation. During the review of the observation report, both parties should sign the form. The faculty member will submit the form to the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) and the Graduate Assistant.

Name of Graduate Assistant Instructor: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Course Number and Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Name of Evaluator: \_\_\_\_\_

### Course Syllabus and Schedule

1. The Graduate Assistant wrote the syllabus (yes/no) or followed a prescribed syllabus (yes/no)?  
**If the GA designed and wrote the syllabus, answer questions b – e below)**

- |                                                                                      |     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| a) Does the syllabus set out clear learning objectives for the course?               | Yes |
| No                                                                                   |     |
| b) Is the syllabus well organized and conceptualized?                                | Yes |
| No                                                                                   |     |
| c) Is the instructor covering the major areas that should be covered in this course? |     |
| Yes      No                                                                          |     |
| d) Does the syllabus make clear the basis for grading?                               | Yes |
| No                                                                                   |     |
| e) The GTA adhered to the course schedule and syllabus?                              | Yes |
| No                                                                                   |     |

### Course Observation

1. Non-evaluative description of the class you visited. Which of the following did it include?



- |                  |     |    |
|------------------|-----|----|
| a) Lecture       | Yes | No |
| b) Discussion    | Yes | No |
| c) Critique      | Yes | No |
| d) Demonstration | Yes | No |
| e) Other? _____  |     |    |

## Class Evaluation

### Rating Scale:

**4 – Strongly Agree    3 – Agree    2 – Disagree    1 – Strongly Disagree    Not Observed**

- |                                                                                       |   |   |   |   |              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|--------------|
| a) The GTA is professional, punctual, and prepared for class.                         | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| b) The GTA communicated interest in the subject.                                      | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| c) The GTA has a thorough knowledge of the material.                                  | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| d) The GTA encouraged student participation.                                          | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| e) The GTA asked questions or made comments that generated critical thinking.         | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| f) The GTA interacted well with students and addressed students' needs and questions. | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| g) The GTA made appropriate use of ( <i>technology/instruments/texts/readings</i> ).  | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| h) The material was well organized.                                                   | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| i) The material was well clearly presented.                                           | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |
| j) The GTA used time well.                                                            | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | Not Observed |

**Overall Assessment of Instruction:**      **Meets Expectations**                      **Below Expectations**

Comments if Needed:

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Graduate Assistant's Signature/Date

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Supervising Instructor's Signature/Date